

Project XTC – Development Edition 0.1

Chapter 4 – Modes

What Is a Mode?

A mode changes the meaning of the controls without changing the hardware. The same encoder can adjust pan, a synth parameter or a send level depending on the current mode.

Common Modes

Mixer: track levels and pan.

Device: parameters of the selected device.

Sends: send levels.

Browser: browsing and loading content.

Why Modes Exist

Without modes, the controller would need hundreds of dedicated controls. Reusing the same high-quality controls in different contexts keeps the surface compact while giving access to far more of Bitwig.

Practical Exercise

Turn a V-Pot in Mixer mode, switch to Device mode and turn the same V-Pot again. The physical action is identical, but the function has changed.

Field Note #006

When something behaves unexpectedly, check the current mode before assuming there is a fault.

Key Takeaways

- Modes change meanings, not hardware.
- Read the scribble strips—they describe the current context.